

FinRep — Project Overview & Roadmap

A plain-language guide to what we're building, why, and where it's going

Prepared: June 2026 · **Status:** Phase 1 complete (foundation shipped) · **Audience:** Everyone — no technical background required

1. The one-paragraph summary

FinRep is software that turns a school's raw accounting export into finished, audit-ready financial statements in minutes instead of days.

Today, when a school's bookkeeper needs to produce financial statements, they export a "trial balance" (a long list of every account and its balance) and then manually rearrange those numbers — in spreadsheets, by hand — into the formal reports that boards, auditors, and banks require. It's slow, error-prone, and has to be redone every reporting period. FinRep automates that rearrangement: upload the export, and the polished statements appear on screen, ready to print to PDF or download as Excel.

2. The problem we're solving

Schools (and similar nonprofit organizations) are required to produce a specific set of financial statements on a regular basis. Picture a bookkeeper at a private school:

- Their accounting system spits out a **trial balance** — a raw list like "Account 4100 – Tuition: \$2.4M, Account 6200 – Teacher Salaries: \$1.8M..." — sometimes hundreds of lines long.
- The board, the auditor, and the bank don't want that raw list. They want **formal statements**: "Here is our total revenue, here are our expenses by category, here is what we own and owe, here is our cash flow."
- Getting from the raw list to the formal statements means knowing **which raw account belongs in which line of which statement** — and doing that math correctly, the same way, every single time.

Doing this by hand in spreadsheets is the status quo. The problems with the status quo:

Pain point	What it costs the school
Manual & repetitive	Hours of skilled staff time every reporting period
Error-prone	One mis-typed number or mis-categorized account throws off the whole statement
Hard to reproduce	Six months later, nobody can perfectly recreate how a past statement was built
Inconsistent	Two people doing it produce two slightly different results
Not audit-friendly	Auditors want to trace every number back to its source — spreadsheets hide that trail

3. What FinRep does (the solution)

FinRep replaces the manual spreadsheet work with a guided, automated workflow:

1. **Sign in** securely to your school's account.
2. **Upload** the trial-balance file(s) exported from your accounting system.
3. **Pick the reporting period** (e.g. "Fiscal Year 2026") and the period-end date.
4. **Generate.** FinRep instantly produces the formal statements.
5. **Review** them on screen, then **print to PDF** or **export to a formatted Excel workbook**.

The statements FinRep produces are the standard set used in nonprofit/school accounting:

- **Statement of Activities** — revenue and expenses (the "did we make or lose money" statement).
- **Statement of Financial Position** — what the school owns and owes (the "net worth" snapshot).
- **Statement of Cash Flows** — where cash actually came from and went.
- **Statement of Net Assets** — how the school's accumulated value rolled forward over the period.

It can also show a **prior-year comparison** column and flag any accounts it doesn't recognize, so nothing silently falls through the cracks.

4. Why our approach is trustworthy

Two design principles set FinRep apart from a do-it-yourself spreadsheet. Both matter a great deal to auditors and boards.

Principle 1 — The math is consistent and provable

The part of FinRep that does the financial calculations is built as a **sealed, self-contained "engine."** Give it the same inputs and it *always* returns the exact same numbers — there's no hidden randomness, no dependence on who ran it or when. This is verified by an automated test suite that runs every time we make a change, so the calculations can't silently drift over time.

In plain terms: It's a calculator we can prove is right, not a spreadsheet someone might have fat-fingered.

Principle 2 — Every statement is fully reproducible and traceable

When FinRep saves a finished statement, it doesn't just save the final numbers. It records **exactly what went into them:**

- the original uploaded file, frozen and never altered ("immutable"),
- the precise version of the rules used to categorize each account,
- the version of the calculation engine that produced it.

Because of this, anyone can later re-run the process and get a **byte-for-byte identical** result. If a number on a statement is ever questioned, we can trace it all the way back to the original source line. Corrections are never made by quietly editing history — they create a new record, so the audit trail is always intact.

In plain terms: Every number can be traced back to its source, and old reports never silently change. This is exactly what auditors look for.

5. How the pieces fit together

FinRep is built as a set of cooperating parts. You don't need to know the technology names — here's what each part *does*, by analogy to a business:

Part	Plain-language role	Business analogy
The Engine	Does all the financial math and produces the statements	The expert accountant who knows every rule cold
The Importer	Reads the uploaded spreadsheet and cleans it up	The clerk who opens the mail and sorts the paperwork
The Records / Database	Securely stores accounts, users, uploads, and finished statements	The locked, organized filing cabinet
The Service (API)	The behind-the-scenes coordinator that connects everything	The office manager routing work between people
The Website (App)	The screens you actually click and type into	The front desk you walk up to

Everything is organized as a single, well-structured project so these parts stay consistent with one another and can be improved independently.

Who can do what (roles)

FinRep supports multiple people working on the same school, with appropriate permissions:

- **Owner** — full control, including managing the team and settings.
- **Accountant** — can do the financial work (upload, generate, review).
- **Viewer** — can look at results but not change anything.

Schools are grouped under an **Organization** (useful for a group that operates several schools), and team members are added by **email invitation**.

6. The roadmap — phases at a glance

We're delivering FinRep in clearly-defined phases so value lands early and risk stays low.

Phase 1 is the foundation — a working, secure, multi-user product (sub-phases **1A → 1D**).

Phases 2+ layer the high-value modules (compliance, board reporting, analytics, benchmarking, integrations) on top of the proven engine.

Phase 1 — Foundation (a secure, multi-user product)

Phase	What it delivers	Status
1A — Foundation	The core service is alive: connects to the database, reports its own health, and exposes the report-generation engine	✓ Complete
1B — Accounts & Access	Real user accounts, secure sign-in, organizations/schools, teams, roles, invitations	✓ Complete
1B.5 — Settings & Member Management	A full Settings area: members & roles, school settings, your account, organization	✓ Complete
1C — Saving & History	Store uploads and finished statements so work persists, history is kept, and prior-year comparatives auto-load	✓ Complete
1D — Billing	Subscriptions, free trials, and paid plans	✓ Complete

Phases 2+ — High-value modules (built on the engine)

Phase	What it delivers	Status
2 — AUP Readiness & Year-End Review	Florida scholarship-compliance prep + end-of-year review readiness: exception pre-flagging, scholarship reconciliation, workpapers, corrective-action plans	✓ Complete
3 — Board & Finance-Committee Reporting	Period-over-period, budget vs. actual, one-click board packet (PDF), scheduled delivery	📋 Planned
4 — Analytics & Insights Dashboard	A customizable per-school dashboard: cost per pupil, financial-aid-per-student, days cash on hand, and more — metrics each school can tailor	📋 Planned
5 — Peer Benchmarking	Compare a school against an anonymized cohort of similar schools on the Phase-4 metrics	📋 Planned
6 — Integrations & Automation	QuickBooks Online and scholarship-software connectors (no-file intake), auto-reconciliation, scheduled jobs	📋 Planned
7 — Hardening & Trust	SOC 2 readiness, single sign-on, scale, billing maturity	📋 Planned

A note on data: Phases 2, 4, and 5 introduce inputs **beyond the trial balance** — student **enrollment** counts, **financial-aid / scholarship** disbursements, and (exploratory) academic data. We capture those alongside the financials so the metrics and compliance checks have what they need.

The sections below break each phase down.

7. The roadmap — phase by phase

Phase 1A — Foundation Complete

Goal: Stand up the behind-the-scenes service and prove the calculation engine works end-to-end.

What's done: - The core service runs and can confirm it's healthy and connected to its database (a built-in "is everything OK?" check). - The financial **engine is wired in** and can generate a full set of statements on demand. - The project is structured so all the pieces build and run together reliably.

Why it matters: This is the foundation the rest of the product stands on. It's plumbing the customer never sees directly — but nothing else works without it.

Phase 1B — Accounts & Access Complete

Goal: Make FinRep a real, secure, multi-user product that a school's team can actually log into.

What's done: - **User accounts** with email-and-password sign-up and secure sign-in. - **Email verification** to confirm new accounts are real. - **Password reset** ("forgot password") and the ability to change your password. - **Account protection** — passwords are stored in a securely scrambled form (never in plain text), and accounts temporarily lock after repeated failed sign-in attempts to block guessing attacks. - **Organizations and schools** — set up your organization and the school(s) under it. - **Teams and roles** — invite colleagues by email and assign them Owner, Accountant, or Viewer permissions. - **A Settings area** — manage your profile, your organization, your school details, and your team members from a clean interface. - **An audit log** — the system keeps a record of significant actions for accountability.

Why it matters: This turns a single-user tool into something a whole finance team can use safely, with the right people having the right level of access.

Phase 1B.5 — Settings & Member Management Complete

Goal: Give Owners a real interface to manage their team and school — not just behind-the-scenes permissions.

What's done: - A dedicated **Settings** area with a sidebar: **My Account, Members & Roles, School**, and **Organization**. - **Members & Roles** — invite people, change a member's role, remove a member, and see/cancel pending invitations, with **last-owner protection** (you can't accidentally lock a school out by removing its only Owner). - **School Settings** — edit the school's name and its opening net-asset balances. - **My Account** —

update your name and change your password. - **Organization** — name your organization and see the schools it manages.

Why it matters: Owners can run their own team without needing support — the day-to-day control that makes a multi-user product self-serve.

Phase 1C — Saving & History Complete

Goal: Make work persist. The heavy lifting no longer happens only in the moment; we now store the inputs and results so nothing is lost and history is preserved.

What's done: - **Uploads are saved** exactly as received and never altered, so they remain a permanent, trustworthy record. - **Finished statements are stored** and can be reopened, compared, and re-printed later — no need to re-upload and regenerate. - **Prior-year comparatives auto-load** from history — once a year is on file, the next year's comparison column fills in automatically with no re-upload. - **Full version history** of the categorization rules and the engine, so any past statement can be reproduced perfectly (see the reproducibility principle in Section 4). - **Work survives a refresh** — reopen the app and your in-progress period is restored from the saved record.

Why it matters: Schools get a durable, auditable archive of their financial reporting, not just a one-time render on screen.

Phase 1D — Billing Complete

Goal: Turn FinRep into a sustainable subscription product.

What's done: - **Subscription plans** (monthly / yearly) with secure payment handling via Stripe. - **A free trial on every new school** — 14 days to evaluate before paying, with no card required up front. - **Access tied to subscription status** — generating and saving statements requires an active subscription or a live trial; if a trial lapses or a payment fails, those paid actions pause (while sign-in, settings, and viewing existing data stay open) until billing is brought current. - **Owner-managed billing in Settings** — Owners subscribe, switch plans, and open a secure billing portal; Accountants and Viewers see status only. - **A trusted payment record** — Stripe's signed notifications keep the app's subscription status in sync automatically, and every billing change is written to the audit log.

Why it matters: This is how the product funds its own ongoing development and support — and it completes Phase 1: FinRep is now a secure, multi-user, saleable product end to end. *(Live card processing activates once the operator adds their Stripe keys; everything else is built and verified.)*

Phase 2 — AUP Readiness & Year-End Review Complete

Goal: Make Florida private schools' mandatory **scholarship-compliance review (AUP)** and their **year-end financial review** far less manual — catching problems before the auditor does.

What's done — grounded in researched, cited Florida statutes + the Step Up For Students AUP template (see [docs/PHASE_2_AUP_RESEARCH.md](#)), delivered as a **Review Readiness** workspace: - **2A — Exception pre-flagging** — a **versioned** rules engine (statute-year + program-tier pinned) scans each period for likely audit findings (books don't balance, education expenses below scholarship funds, non-education expenditures, the \$250k AUP trigger, FDIC/60-day-reconciliation/DOE-status controls, FES-UA-specific limits). Each finding carries a **pass / reportable / material** status and its statute citation. A short attestation intake makes most checks produce a real verdict. - **2B — Scholarship reconciliation** — upload the funding organization's disbursement records (parsed in-browser) and reconcile them against the recorded scholarship revenue, with per-program / per-month breakdowns, a matched/variance verdict, and anomaly flags (duplicates, negatives, out-of-period dates, unknown program). - **2C — Year-end review readiness** — a guided checklist (a procedure item per AUP rule + a document-gathering list) with progress tracking, **plus a one-click Workpapers Packet** that aggregates the statements, findings, reconciliation, and corrective-action plan into a clean, print-ready document for the reviewer. - **2D — Corrective Action Plan scaffolding** — every **material** finding auto-scaffolds a pre-filled, editable CAP entry (root cause, corrective action, responsible party, target date, status) that persists and exports; entries self-resolve when the underlying finding clears. - **Built to adapt** — the checks are **versioned configuration, not hard-coded rules**, so a procedure change is a settings/version bump, not a software release.

Framing: this is a **readiness pre-flag** that mirrors the published AUP — clearly labeled as *not* the official AUP submission or legal/audit advice. (*Automatic disbursement pull from the funding-org system is Phase 6; here the records are uploaded.*)

Why it matters: This is the wedge — it turns a stressful, manual annual scramble into a guided, mostly-automated process. (*Scholarship data can be uploaded manually here; Phase 6 adds the automatic connector.*)

Phase 3 — Board & Finance-Committee Reporting Planned

Goal: Produce the recurring reports a school's board and finance committee expect — in one click.

What it will deliver: - **Period-over-period** comparisons and **budget vs. actual / variance**. - A **one-click board packet (PDF)** combining the statements, comparatives,

and variances. - An optional plain-language **narrative summary**. - **Scheduled delivery** — e.g., the monthly packet generated and emailed automatically.

Why it matters: Replaces hours of monthly spreadsheet assembly with a single click — or a hands-off automated email.

Phase 4 — Analytics & Insights Dashboard **Planned**

Goal: Give each school an at-a-glance dashboard of the financial metrics that matter **to them** — customizable, because every school cares about different things.

What it will deliver: - **Key metrics out of the box** — **cost per pupil** (total cost ÷ enrollment), **financial-aid metrics** (e.g., aid per student), **days cash on hand**, tuition dependency, net tuition per student. - **A customizable dashboard** — schools choose which metrics to feature and how to view them. - **New inputs captured** — these metrics need a little more than the trial balance (student **enrollment** counts and **financial-aid/scholarship** totals), which we collect alongside the financials.

Why it matters: Turns the statements from once-a-year compliance documents into ongoing operational insight a head of school can use.

Phase 5 — Peer Benchmarking **Planned**

Goal: Let a school see how it stacks up against comparable schools — privately.

What it will deliver: - Compare against an **anonymized cohort** on the Phase-4 ratios (days cash on hand, tuition dependency, cost per pupil, aid per student). - **Cohorts** by size / region / type, **privacy-safe** — no individual school is identifiable and minimum cohort sizes are enforced.

Why it matters: Context a single school can't get alone — "is our cost per pupil normal for a school our size?"

Phase 6 — Integrations & Automation **Planned**

Goal: Cut out manual file wrangling by connecting directly to the systems schools already use.

What it will deliver: - **QuickBooks Online connector** — pull the trial balance directly, no file upload. - **Scholarship-software connector** — integrate with the scholarship funding-organization systems (e.g., Step Up For Students) to pull disbursement data automatically, powering the **AUP reconciliation (Phase 2)** and the **aid metrics (Phase 4)**. - **Auto-**

reconciliation and an **automatic exception scan on every import**. - **Scheduled jobs** (e.g., the monthly board packet) running reliably in the background.

Why it matters: The difference between "export a file and upload it" and "it's already done." This is also where the scholarship integration you flagged comes to life.

Phase 7 — Hardening & Trust Planned

Goal: Enterprise-grade trust and scale.

What it will deliver: - **SOC 2 readiness** — the security credential auditors and schools will ask for. - **Single sign-on** (Google / Microsoft). - **Billing maturity** (dunning, seats) and the performance/reliability to serve hundreds of schools.

Why it matters: This is what lets FinRep serve many schools and pass their security reviews.

Future / Exploratory

Ideas worth pursuing once the core platform is mature — flagged as research, not committed scope: - **Blended academic + financial metrics** — bringing academic indicators (e.g., **test scores**) alongside the financial picture so a school can view **cost and outcomes together**. This needs an academic-data source and careful handling of student-related data (privacy/FERPA), so it's exploratory and would be scoped separately.

8. Where things stand today (June 2026)

-  The financial **engine is built, tested, and verified** — the hard, high-risk accounting logic is done and proven.
-  The **foundation (1A)** is complete and running.
-  **Accounts, security, teams (1B)** and the full **Settings & member-management area (1B.5)** are complete — FinRep is a real multi-user application.
-  **Saving & history (1C)** is complete — uploads and statements persist, history is kept, and prior-year comparatives auto-load.
-  **Billing (1D)** is complete — subscriptions, free trials, and subscription-gated access, all managed from Settings.
-  **Phase 1 is finished.** FinRep is now a secure, multi-user, persistent, **saleable** product end to end.

-  **The Analytics & Insights dashboard (Phase 4)** is complete — a customizable per-school dashboard with health-status metrics, drill-down, AI-style insights, and freshness cues (pulled forward ahead of 2–3).
-  **AUP Readiness & Year-End Review (Phase 2)** is complete — a researched, cited, versioned compliance **Review Readiness** workspace: exception pre-flagging (2A), scholarship reconciliation (2B), year-end checklist + one-click workpapers packet (2C), and corrective-action-plan scaffolding (2D).
-  **Remaining modules — board reporting (3), peer benchmarking (5), integrations including the scholarship-software connector (6), and hardening/SOC 2 (7)** — are planned and build directly on the proven engine + the analytics and compliance layers now in place.

The biggest technical risk — getting the accounting math exactly right and provably consistent — is already behind us, and the foundation, analytics, and compliance layers now stand on top of it. What remains is board-facing reporting, cross-school benchmarking, direct integrations, and enterprise hardening — layered onto a product that already stores, secures, monetizes, analyzes, and compliance-checks the work the engine does correctly.

9. What FinRep is *not* (scope clarity)

To set expectations clearly with non-technical stakeholders:

- FinRep is **not** a full accounting system. It doesn't replace the bookkeeping software where transactions are recorded. It sits **downstream**, turning that software's output into finished statements.
 - FinRep does **not** invent or guess numbers. It rearranges and totals the numbers you give it, using transparent, traceable rules.
 - FinRep does **not** lock you in. Results export to standard **PDF** and **Excel** formats you already use.
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10. Glossary (plain-language definitions)

- **Trial balance** — the raw list of every account and its balance, exported from accounting software. FinRep's starting input.
- **Financial statements** — the formal reports (Activities, Financial Position, Cash Flows, Net Assets) that boards, auditors, and banks require.
- **Reporting period** — the span of time a statement covers, e.g. a fiscal year.

- **Net assets** — a nonprofit's accumulated value; the equivalent of "net worth" or "equity."
 - **The Engine** — FinRep's sealed calculator that does the financial math identically every time.
 - **Reproducible** — able to be recreated exactly, down to the last cent, from the original inputs.
 - **Immutable** — saved in a form that is never altered, preserving a trustworthy record.
 - **Audit trail** — the traceable path from a final number back to its original source.
 - **Role (Owner / Accountant / Viewer)** — a person's permission level within a school.
 - **Organization** — the top-level account that can contain one or more schools.
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This document describes the product vision and delivery plan. Phase status reflects the state of the project as of June 2026 (Phases 1, 4, and 2 complete — foundation, analytics dashboard, and AUP/year-end readiness all shipped; Phases 3, 5, 6, 7 planned) and will be updated as phases complete. The full plan now runs through Phase 7 plus exploratory work — see Sections 6–7. The companion `PROJECT_OVERVIEW.pdf` is generated from this Markdown via `scripts/md-to-pdf.py`; re-run it after edits to keep the two in sync.